

## **FIRE ALARM AND EMERGENCY EVACUATION POLICY**

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### **Purpose**

Gurdwara Guru Granth Sahib Punjabi School is committed to providing a safe environment for all pupils, staff, volunteers, parents and visitors. This policy outlines the procedures to be followed in the event of a fire alarm or emergency evacuation.

The safety of everyone attending the Punjabi School is our highest priority.

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### **Fire Alarm Procedure**

If the fire alarm sounds:

- Treat every fire alarm as a genuine emergency.
  - Remain calm and act immediately.
  - Stop all teaching and learning activities.
  - Follow the instructions of teachers or volunteers.
  - Leave all personal belongings behind.
  - Evacuate the building using the nearest safe fire exit.
  - Walk calmly at all times. Do not run or push.
  - Never ignore the fire alarm or assume it is a false alarm or test.
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### **Evacuation Procedure**

Everyone must:

- Leave the building immediately using the nearest available fire exit.
- Follow the directions given by teachers and volunteers.
- Help younger pupils where appropriate.
- Stay together as a class during the evacuation.

- Proceed directly to the designated Fire Assembly Point.

The designated Fire Assembly Point for Punjabi School is:

### **Cycle Stand**

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#### **At the Assembly Point**

Once outside the building:

- Move well away from the building.
  - Keep all entrances and access routes clear for emergency services.
  - Remain with your class and teacher.
  - Teachers will take a register to ensure all pupils are safely accounted for.
  - Any missing person must be reported immediately to the School Coordinator.
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#### **During Class Assessments**

If the fire alarm sounds during a class assessment:

- Pupils must stop writing immediately.
  - Leave all assessment materials on the desk unless instructed otherwise.
  - Follow the teacher's instructions.
  - Leave the building quietly and safely.
  - Do not discuss the assessment until instructed that it is safe to continue.
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#### **Re-entering the Building**

No one may re-enter the building until permission has been given by:

- The Fire and Rescue Service, or
- The responsible person from the Gurdwara.

Do not return to the building to collect personal belongings during an evacuation.

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#### **Responsibilities**

## **School Coordinator**

The School Coordinator will:

- Liaise with Gurdwara Management regarding fire safety arrangements.
- Ensure all teachers and volunteers are familiar with evacuation procedures.

## **Teachers and Volunteers**

Teachers and volunteers will:

- Remain calm and reassure pupils.
- Lead pupils safely to the assembly point.
- Carry out a register.
- Report any concerns immediately.
- Ensure no pupil returns to the building without permission.

## **Pupils**

Pupils must:

- Follow instructions immediately.
- Leave the building quickly and calmly.
- Stay with their class and teacher.
- Never re-enter the building until instructed.

## **Parents and Visitors**

Parents and visitors must:

- Follow instructions from staff.
- Proceed to the assembly point.
- Keep emergency access routes clear.
- Wait for further instructions before returning to the building.

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## **Fire Safety Awareness**

Everyone attending Punjabi School should:

- Know the location of the nearest fire exits.

- Keep exits and corridors clear at all times.
  - Report any fire hazards immediately.
  - Never interfere with fire safety equipment.
  - Follow all fire safety signs displayed within the Gurdwara.
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### **Review**

This policy will be reviewed annually by the Punjabi School Management Committee or sooner if fire safety procedures change.

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### **Policy Statement**

Gurdwara Guru Granth Sahib Punjabi School is committed to maintaining a safe learning environment. All pupils, staff, volunteers, parents and visitors have a shared responsibility to follow fire safety procedures and cooperate fully during any emergency evacuation.